

+-----+ The Maplewood Gazette +-----+ Est. Since Always "All The News Fit To Print (And Some That Isn't)" Vol. XLII — No. 7 TUESDAY, 2000 • PRICE: 50 CENTS • LATE CITY EDITION +-----+		
FERA'S PIZZERIA DINER SHUTTERED AMID CRIMINAL INVESTIGATION		
By Staff Reporter — The beloved Fera's Pizzeria Diner , a staple of the community for over a decade, was ordered closed late last evening following a multi-agency investigation into the conduct of one of its long-standing resident entertainers. Authorities confirmed that the individual at the center of the inquiry, known internally as JAY , has been formally detained and placed under permanent isolation within the premises, pending ongoing proceedings that officials declined to detail publicly. "We are not at liberty to disclose the full nature of the allegations," said a spokesperson, "but we can confirm the establishment will not reopen to the public until further notice." The closure has sent shockwaves through the local community, many of whom considered the diner a safe family gathering spot. Several families who spoke to this reporter expressed disbelief.	Sources close to the investigation suggest the allegations involve a pattern of behaviour over an extended period — behaviour that management allegedly failed to address despite repeated internal reports. The Pizzeria's ownership has not commented publicly. In an unusual arrangement, oversight of the remaining residents — described by staff as "biological entities under protective custody" — has been handed to an individual identified only as BLAZE , an Umbreon associated with private security contracting. Here is what the police said about him QUOTE: " He keeps them in check. That's all anyone needs to know. " Blaze has reportedly declined all press requests and has not appeared publicly since taking the role. Neighbours report seeing lights on inside the diner during overnight hours.	The remaining residents — Fera, May, and Jason — are confirmed to still be housed within the facility. Their conditions have not been disclosed, though welfare advocates have called for an independent inspection to happen at Sunday when BLAZE is confirmed to not be at the building anymore. City council members are divided on whether the building should be permanently decommissioned or repurposed. A vote is expected next quarter, assuming the investigation concludes. This newspaper will continue to follow developments as they emerge. Readers with information are encouraged to contact our anonymous tip line. — Additional reporting by the Night Desk
<IMAGE HERE>		
EDUCATOR FOUND DEAD IN BACK ALLEY; CIRCUMSTANCES DESCRIBED AS 'DELIBERATE' By Crime Correspondent The body of Autumn Wine , a Lucario employed as an educator at a local institution, was discovered in the back alley adjacent to his workplace in the early hours of Tuesday morning. According to the city medical examiner, Wine was found inside a scented refuse bag. The examination revealed severe trauma consistent with deliberate acts: both eyes had been removed, multiple fingers severed, and the throat identified as the site of the fatal injury. "The murderer seemed to make sure his pain lasted as long as they could before ending his life," one investigator told this paper on condition of anonymity. Wine was described by colleagues as a dedicated professional who "helped everyone." No motive has been established. No suspects have been named. The case remains open. [EDITOR'S NOTE: A candlelight vigil is planned for Thursday evening at the school gates.]	CITY COUNCIL APPROVES NEW STREETLAMP CONTRACT The downtown improvement committee voted 7-2 in favour of a new six-year streetlamp maintenance contract. Critics called the decision "illuminating, if overdue." WEATHER: OVERCAST WITH CHANCE OF SOMETHING WRONG Meteorologists predict continued overcast conditions through the weekend. Residents are advised to keep their windows closed and their doors locked. Authorities did not elaborate on the second recommendation. LETTERS TO THE EDITOR "I walked past that diner last night. The lights were on and I heard something that sounded like humming. I don't think it was a person. I haven't slept since." — Anonymous, District 4	ADVERTISEMENT ARE YOU UNSATISFIED? Did you know you can grow your PENIS 3 TIMES IN SIZE with our patented all-natural formula? Results in as little as 6 weeks! (Results not typical. Not responsible for consequences.) CALL NOW: 1-800-BIG-DEAL
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